

Before you actually reach the video editing part, you need to source the video first. For this, you can use a variety of devices, the primary one being a video capture card. A video capture card is installed in the PCI slot of the computer, if it is internal and it is connected to the computer using a USB2.0 or Firewire port, if it is external. You connect the other device—a VHS player or a camcorder to the video capture card. Once you do that, you can transfer your video from the camcorder or VHS player to the computer. Newer digital camcorders come installed with Firewire or USB connectivity, which makes the capture card redundant. It's definitely a plus if you have a digital camcorder or camera.



A Web cam

Other devices that are used for video are Web cams, TV tuners and digital cameras. Whatever the video source, your main aim is to plug-in the device to the computer, and make sure it works fine. Once that's done, you can rest easy.

Installing the devices is an easy task in Windows XP—all you need to do is connect the Web cam or TV tuner or digital camera to the FireWire or USB port, whichever the device supports. If the device provides connectivity for both FireWire (aka IEEE 1394) and USB 2.0, and your computer has a FireWire port, then we suggest that you use the FireWire port for connectivity. While a USB 2.0 port theoretically supports a 12 Mbps data transfer rate, FireWire, theoretically specified at 1600 Mbps, is more than adequate for all your video editing requirements.

Users receive individual manuals and drivers on purchasing the aforementioned devices. While connecting the devices to the computer is rather easy, installing the drivers can get tricky.